

GOOD GUY INTERNET

Internet and Social Media have not only become an integral part of our lives, in many aspects they have replaced parts of our lives completely and become a living breathing society in themselves. For instance, in the past 5 years, we have seen Oxford dictionary award Word Of the Year (WOTY) to words like Selfie and Unfriend. In fact, last year the Oxford WOTY was an emoji - the laughing face with tears. Also, there is an increasing call everyday to regulate the online world with stricter laws where earlier there were none. All of this implies that while living online, you need to keep in mind that it is not too different than an offline world and often the same rules and manners are expected to be followed. If you still can't wrap your head around this idea, here's a short dos and don'ts to get you started on being an internet good guy:

DOS

- 1. Use proper privacy settings on each and every website you have an account on -** Privacy settings in the online world are all that stand between your online social life and a complete stranger.
- 2. Control your temper -** Even if someone, particularly a troll, is trying to provoke you a lot, hold onto your anger and ignore the same. Venting out online will always be counterproductive and might even land you in trouble.
- 3. Verify Information -** Before you endorse any information online, like sharing, retweeting or

quoting someone on a forum, always double check it for validity. There is no dearth of misinformation online.

- 4. Encourage newcomers -** If you find someone who is new to the online world and makes a lot of mistakes, instead of ridiculing them try to help them out.

- 5. Keep your online and offline life separated -** Might be the most difficult instruction here, but it is undeniable that real life is way more important than virtual.

DON'Ts

- 1. Don't share your personal details online -** This cannot be stressed enough. Everything from your birth-date to your school's name can be used to either harm you in real life or compromise any of your accounts that uses that information.
- 2. Don't share something against the current organization you are employed with -** Most organisations now have dedicated social media departments and it doesn't take much to track such a post down.
- 3. Don't copy paste things as your own -** Plagiarism is illegal and a punishable offence and there are tools now to detect its occurrence.

the troll, online so that they behave with more accountability.

10 THOU SHALT BE FUNNY

The ultimate weapon against any and every form of troll, online or offline, is your own ability to find humor in their actions and turn it against them. A good sense of humor combined with a presence

of mind can let you feel a sense of satisfaction that even the most brutal revenge can't.

Social Guru: I believe everybody should be given equal opportunity regardless of race, caste, gender and nationality.

Hereto Troll: Oh so you are saying that X people deserve privileges? Have you forgotten ABCD event? Just stop being a bootlicker!!

- 4. Don't do anything suspicious -** Similar to how you treat strangers in real life, don't open emails from unknown sources or open websites that look suspicious.

- 5. And Lastly, Don't over-troll -** A few jokes are funny, but no-one wants to be constantly



It truly is easier to remember the names of all your relatives than all your friends!

hounded and always be at the butt of jokes. Don't over-troll anyone and stop when it's not funny anymore.

Special Mention: Use your common sense - We know it might be a rare resource to expect from others nowadays, but that shouldn't stop you from putting it to use. Most of the time, the action that makes the most sense is the right thing to do, both online and offline. Hold this golden rule at the tip of your fingers.

Social Guru: Good piece of advice. Boots don't taste good either I've heard. Thanks for sharing your valuable experience with me.

Hereto Troll: Don't you get cocky with me! God is watching. He will definitely punish you. I'll see what you do when judgement day comes!

Social Guru: I'll tell you - taking down Skynet! 🇺🇸